Case Report

Cardiac Placement

Subjective Assessment

Presenting Complaint:

The patient attended to cardiac rehab 6 week post Coronary Artery Bypass Graft surgery (CABG). Patient is recovering well and says the wound is healing well with no complications. Feeling well today.

Patent reports shortness of breath on exertion, reduced exercise tolerance. Reports fatigue and occasional burning pain in the centre of chest, which isn't related to exertion and goes away quickly. Patient has been suffering with some anxiety since diagnosis as previous to this didn't realise there was anything wrong, and the surgery had been a big life event for them.

History of Presenting Complaint:

The patient underwent an elective CABG procedure 6 weeks ago due to diagnosis of coronary artery disease. Prior to surgery, he experienced worsening angina over the past 3-4 months, which was unresponsive to medical management. Post-operatively, he had an uneventful recovery but reports feeling deconditioned and breathless with minimal activity.

Past Medical History:

- Hypertension (diagnosed 10 years ago)
- Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus
- Hyperlipidaemia
- Previous smoker (ceased 5 years)
- Hip replacement 3 years ago

Drug History:

- Aspirin 75mg OD
- Clopidogrel 75mg OD
- Atorvastatin 40mg OD
- Metformin 500mg BD
- Bisoprolol 2.5mg OD
- Ramipril 5mg OD
- GTN spray PRN

Social History:

- Retired accountant, lives with spouse

- Previously active, used to walk regularly for 1 hour plus per day. Used to play golf 1/7, and cycle 2/7. Activity is now limited due to breathlessness, and feeling worried.
- Previous smoker, has quit 5 years ago, occasional alcohol consumption
- Supportive family, and children live near by but have busy lives
- Has stairs at home but is able to use them still, a bit slower than previously.

Objective Assessment

General Observation:

- Patient appears well but fatigued
- Midline sternotomy scar healing well
- No signs of distress at rest

Assessments:

Baseline obs:

- Heart Rate: 72 bpm, regular
- Blood Pressure: 128/78
- Oxygen Saturation: 97%
- Blood glucose: 7.2 mmol/L
- Height: 180cm
- Weight: 78kg

Assessment Tests:

- **6-minute walk test:** 300m, with mild dyspnoea
- **Borg scale:** reached 12 at minute 4
- **Post HR:** 95
- **Post BP:** 132/92
- **Time to Resting HR:** 4 min 40 seconds

Impression/Diagnosis:

The patient is recovering well post-CABG and presents with reduced exercise tolerance, mild breathlessness, and post-sternotomy discomfort, limiting physical activity. Patient reported that burning chest pain was relieved by Gaviscon, likely not cardiac related. Patient would like to return to cycling, golf and being able to play with grandchildren. Patient would like to understand more about condition and how to manage. Patient will benefit from Cardiac Rehab Exercise and on initial assessment is ready to begin the program. Patient reports that some movements are painful since

hip surgery but knows his limits and which exercises are OK. Patient will be well suited to an in-person class due to feeling anxious about physical activity.